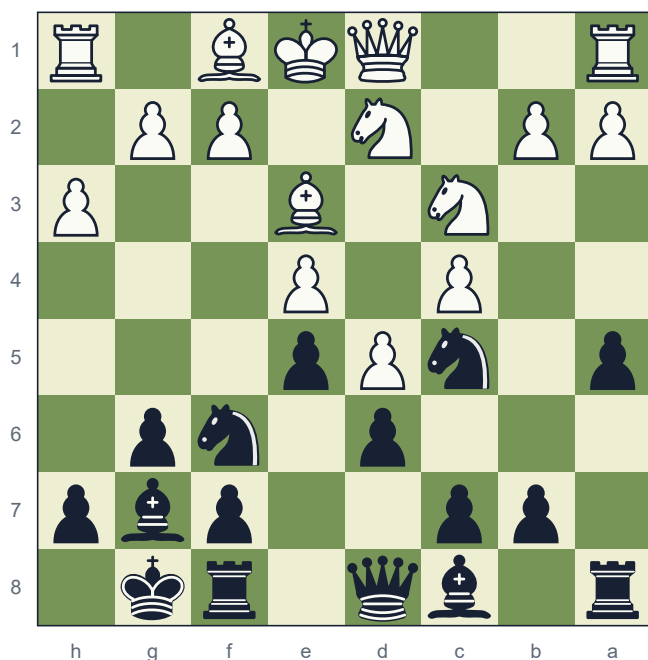


Makogonov and h3 systems

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. h3 O-O 6. Nf3 e5 7. d5 Na6 8. Be3 Nc5

YOUR BLACK REPERTOIRE CHOICE

Use ...e5 against the main h3/Nf3 setup and retain ...Na6 ideas after d5. White is building restraints against ...Bg4, ...Ng4 and a quick kingside attack.



Main study anchor - White to move

READ THE CENTER

h3 keeps the g-pawn flexible and controls g4. White may keep the king in the center, castle short, or attack your king.

WHAT WHITE WANTS

White wants d5, Be3 or Bg5, and sometimes g4. The delayed king choice makes your attacking direction less automatic.

THREE HABITS TO BUILD

1. Identify White's king plan.
2. Do not force ...g5 just because h3 was played.
3. Use ...c6 or queenside squares if the kingside is restrained.

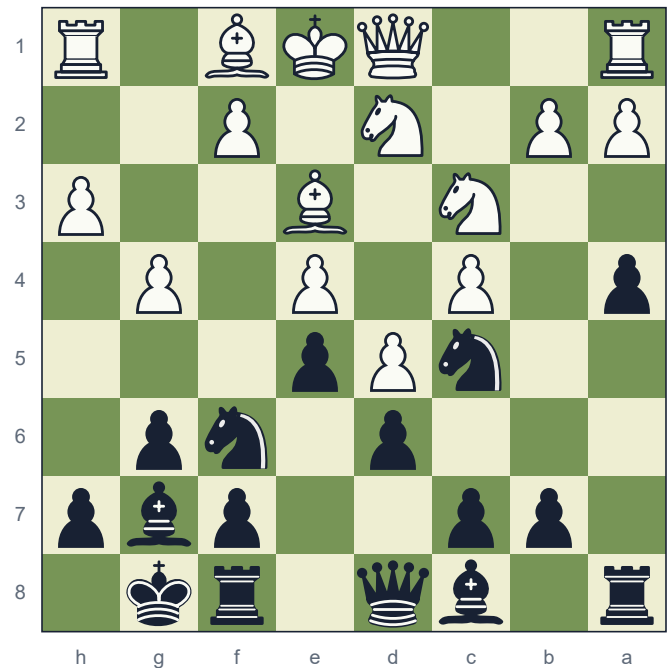
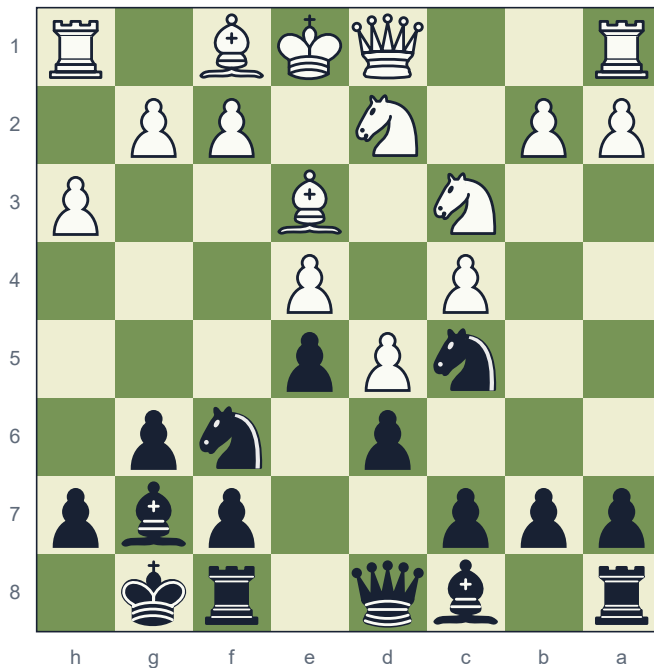
Original repertoire choices and commentary. Public opening names and move-order references, plus local Stockfish checks. Sources and method: Booklet 26.

01 Main h3 and Nf3 structure

STUDY LINE 13-01

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. h3 O-O 6. Nf3 e5 7. d5 Na6 8. Be3 Nc5 9. Nd2 a5 10. g4 a4

Selected anchor ends with 9... a5. Later moves show one checked example.



WHY THESE MOVES

...Na6-c5 develops toward d3, e4 and b3; ...a5 supports the knight against b4. White's h3 removes easy ...Ng4 ideas.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

Improve the queen bishop and prepare a central or kingside break with support. Keep the c5 knight from becoming a fixed target.

WHITE RESOURCE TO RESPECT

White may play g4 and delay castling. A kingside pawn race can then favor White.

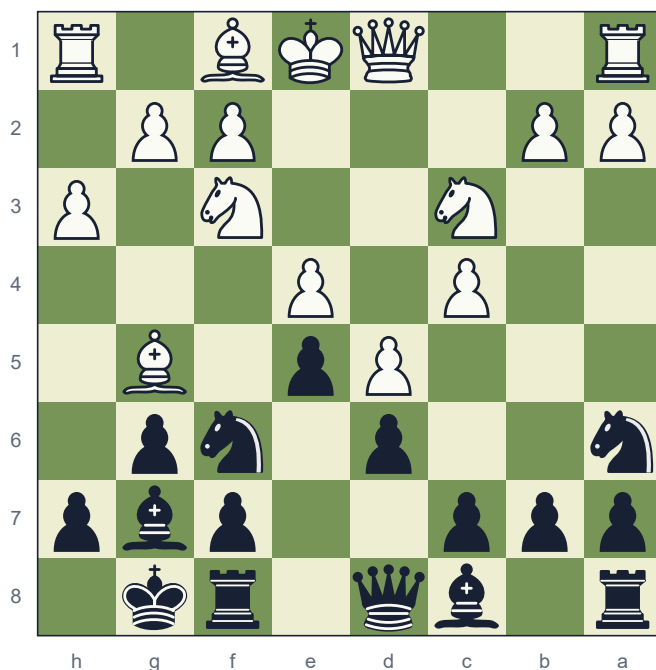
REMEMBER Respect the restraint and find another useful square.

02 White chooses Bg5

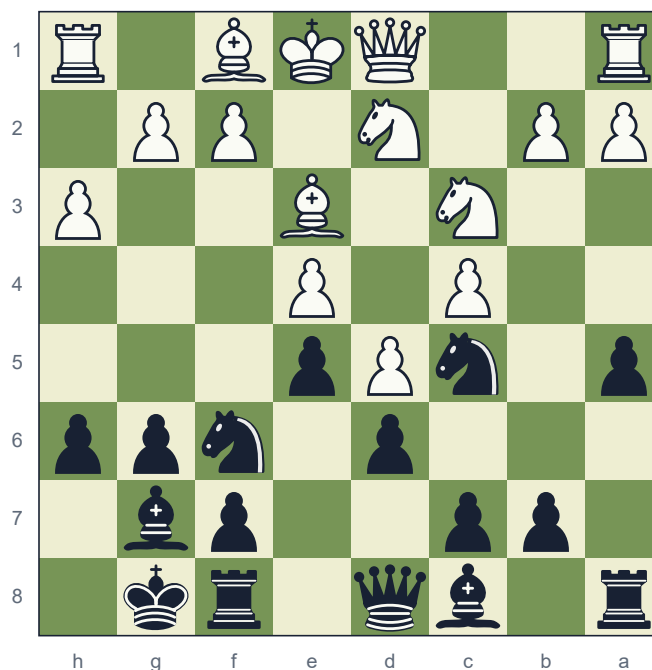
STUDY LINE 13-02

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. h3 O-O 6. Nf3 e5 7. d5 Na6 8. Bg5 h6 9. Be3 Nc5 10. Nd2 a5

Selected anchor ends with 9. Be3. Later moves show one checked example.



Before 8... - Black to move



End of study line - White to move

WHY THESE MOVES

The bishop pins Nf6 along the queen diagonal. ...h6 asks it to choose a square without yet committing ...g5.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

Develop ...Nc5 and consider ...Qe8 or ...Nh7 only when the center is secure. Watch the h6 pawn as a possible target.

WHITE RESOURCE TO RESPECT

White can use h3 to support g4. Do not mistake a bishop retreat for the end of White's attack.

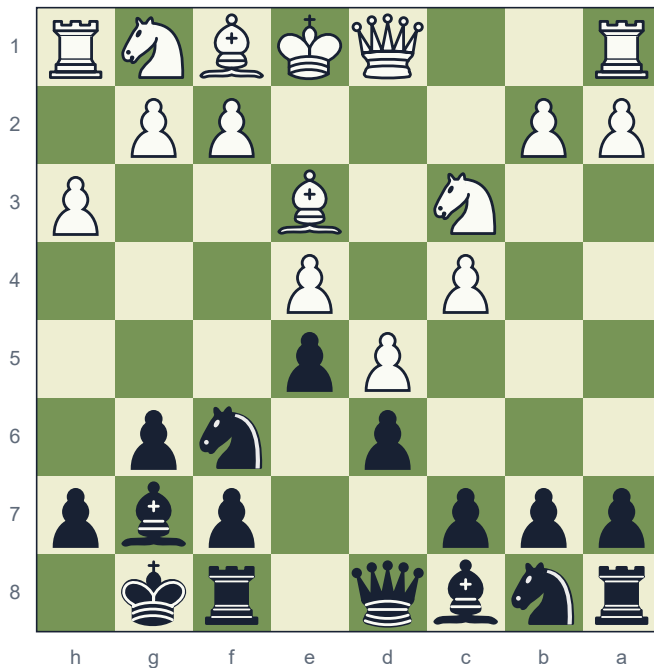
REMEMBER A small question to the bishop is enough for now.

03 Be3 before Nf3

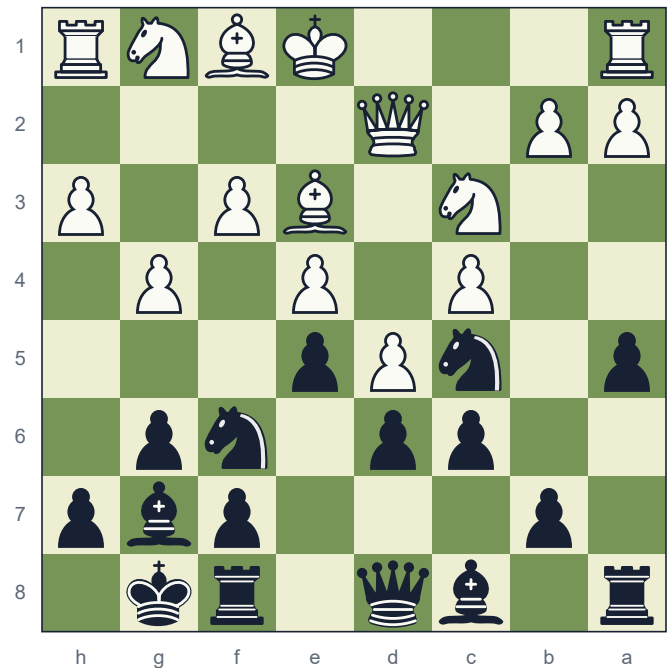
STUDY LINE 13-03

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. h3 O-O 6. Be3 e5 7. d5 Na6 8. g4 Nc5 9. f3 a5 10. Qd2 c6

Selected anchor ends with 7... Na6. Later moves show one checked example.



Before 7... - Black to move



End of study line - White to move

WHY THESE MOVES

White keeps the king knight flexible. Black develops toward c5 while preserving choices for the f6 knight.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

Watch whether White plays Nf3, Nge2 or g4. Choose your break from the resulting position rather than from the move number.

WHITE RESOURCE TO RESPECT

The absence of Nf3 changes which squares are defended and how quickly White can play f4.

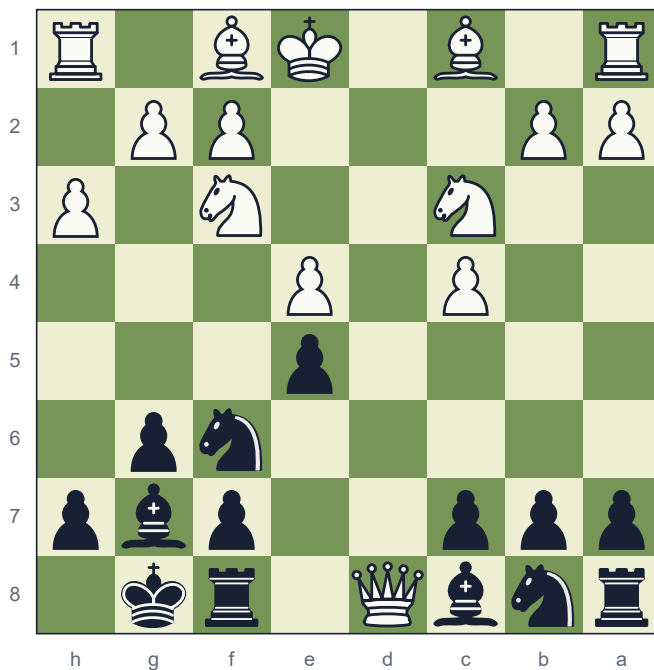
REMEMBER Delayed development can preserve dangerous options.

04 White exchanges rather than closes

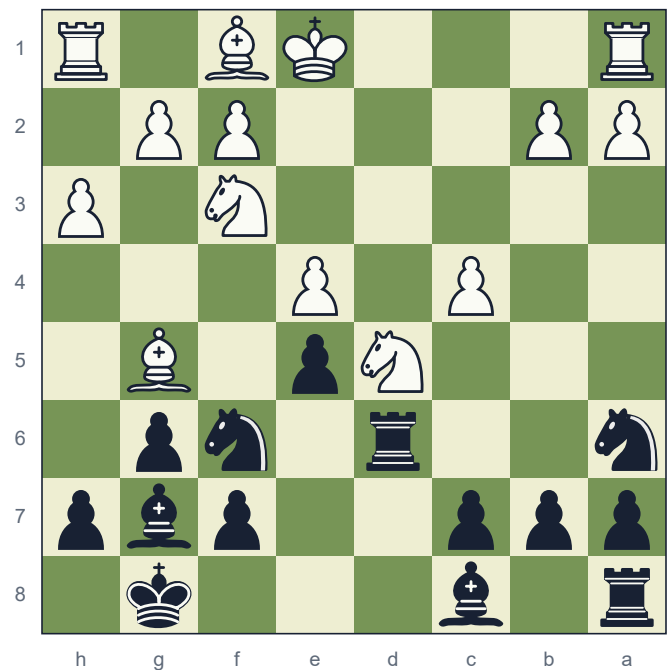
STUDY LINE 13-04

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. h3 O-O 6. Nf3 e5 7. dxe5 dxe5 8. Qxd8 Rxd8 9. Bg5 Na6 10. Nd5 Rd6

Selected anchor ends with 8... Rxd8. Later moves show one checked example.



Before 8... - Black to move



End of study line - White to move

WHY THESE MOVES

The queen exchange makes h3 a useful restraint, but it does not justify a wing attack. Black has an open d-file and active rook.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

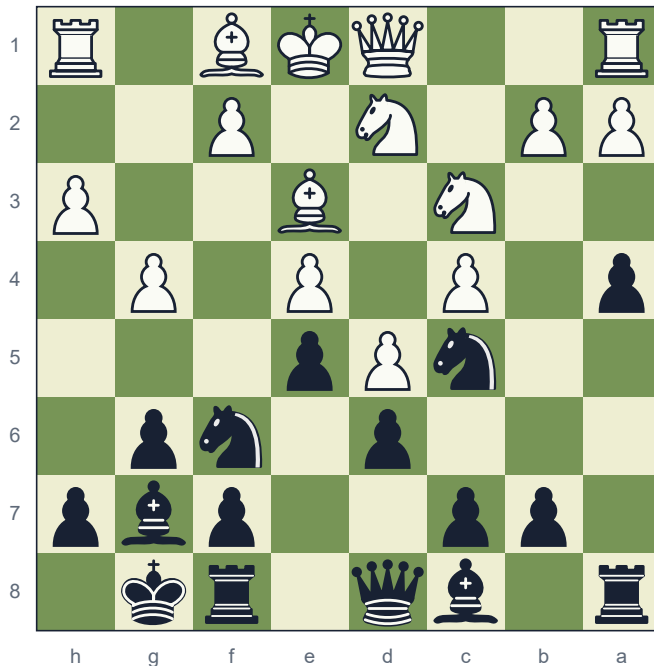
Develop ...Nc6, contest d4 and bring the bishop into play. Compare minor-piece activity before exchanging.

WHITE RESOURCE TO RESPECT

The same h3 label can lead to a completely different center.

REMEMBER The center determines the plan more than the name.

Review before your next game



Main-line endpoint - White to move

1. CLASSIFY THE CENTER

h3 keeps the g-pawn flexible and controls g4. White may keep the king in the center, castle short, or attack your king.

2. NAME WHITE'S COUNTERPLAY

White wants d5, Be3 or Bg5, and sometimes g4. The delayed king choice makes your attacking direction less automatic.

3. CHOOSE A USEFUL JOB

Improve the queen bishop and prepare a central or kingside break with support. Keep the c5 knight from becoming a fixed target.

RECONSTRUCT

Set up the starting position and play this booklet's main line. Before every Black move, state White's threat and why your move is safe. Stop at the first point you cannot explain.

BRANCH TEST

Choose one alternative White move from this booklet. Explain what changed: a defender, a pawn contact, a king choice or a tempo. Then reconstruct the response without looking.

PRACTICE

Play the endpoint against a partner or a chess program, switching colors after one game. Record the first new position and your candidate moves. Use the line ID to find it in Repertoire_Lines.pgn.